

ITINERARY & HISTORY

Odyssey 2026: Journey Through Ancient Greece

PRE-TRAVEL EXPLORATION FOR STUDENTS

Part I: Athens

The Birthplace of Democracy & Philosophy

The Sacred Rock: The Acropolis

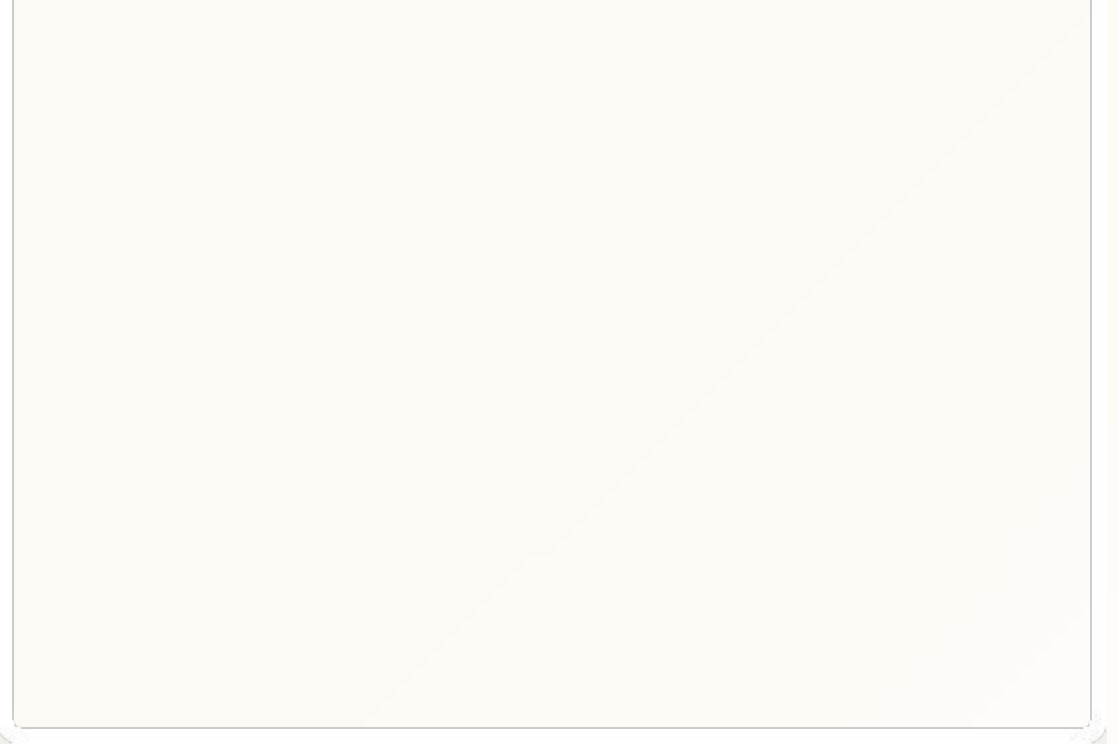
The Parthenon

Dedicated to Athena Parthenos, it is the peak of Doric architecture. Built in the 5th Century BCE with no straight lines—only subtle curves.

Athena Nike

A smaller, elegant Ionic temple honoring victory. It was the first fully Ionic temple on the Acropolis hill.

 Athens Acropolis Sunset



The Olympic Legacy & Artifacts



Panathenaic Stadium

The only stadium in the world built entirely of marble. It hosted the first modern Olympic Games in 1896 and seats over 50,000 people.

Acropolis Museum

A modern architectural marvel housing the original Caryatids—statues of maidens that served as architectural supports for the Erechtheion.

Part II: Crete

The Island of King Minos & Myths

Knossos: The Real Labyrinth

Minoan Civilization: The first high civilization in Europe.

Sophisticated enough to have multi-story plumbing and vibrant frescoes.

The Myth: Legend says King Minos built a labyrinth here to hide the Minotaur. Archaeologists believe the complex palace layout inspired the story.

Arthur Evans: The British archaeologist who "reconstructed" parts of the ruins in the early 1900s, sparking controversy over authenticity.



Spinalonga: Resilience

The Fortress: Originally a Venetian bastion built to protect the Mirabello Bay from the Ottomans.

The Colony: From 1903 to 1957, it was one of the last active leper colonies in Europe. Patients built a self-sufficient community here.

Modern History: Today, it stands as a monument to human endurance and social progress.



Heraklion & Venetian Crossroads



Venetian Harbor

The Koules Fortress guarded the sea entrance for centuries against pirate raids.



Local Flavors

Crete is famous for Graviera cheese and Dakos—barley rusks with tomato and feta.



Night Ferries

Traveling by sea like ancient traders, but with Minoan Lines' modern comfort.

Part III: Santorini

A Masterpiece Carved by
Fire

Akrotiri: 3,600 Years Under Ash

1627
BCE ERUPTION

Frozen in Time

Unlike Pompeii, no human remains were found. The residents had time to evacuate before the volcano exploded.

Advanced Living: Excavations found 3-story houses, elaborate sewage systems, and incredible wall paintings perfectly preserved by ash.



The Cycladic Experience



Oia Sunsets



Black Lava Sands

Opa! Celebrating Tradition

Plate Smashing: Originally to ward off evil spirits, now a high-energy symbol of joy and letting go.

The Word "Opa!": A joyful exclamation used during celebrations, dancing, and of course, breaking plates!

